

**Theorem:** If  $P = NP$ , then  $EXP = NEXP$ .

**Definitions:**

$EXP = \bigcup_{k \geq 1} DTIME(2^{n^k})$  and  $NEXP = \bigcup_{k \geq 1} NTIME(2^{n^k})$ .

**Proof:**

$EXP \subseteq NEXP$  is trivial since deterministic machines are special cases of nondeterministic ones.

We prove  $NEXP \subseteq EXP$  assuming  $P = NP$ .

Let  $L \in NEXP$ . Then there exists a nondeterministic machine  $M$  and constant  $k$  such that  $M$  decides  $L$  in time  $T = 2^{n^k}$ .

Define  $A = \{(x, 1^T) : M \text{ accepts } x \text{ within } T \text{ steps}\}$ .

$A \in NP$  because a certificate is the accepting computation tableau, which can be verified in polynomial time in  $|(x, 1^T)|$ .

Since  $P = NP$ ,  $A \in P$ . So  $A$  can be decided in time polynomial in  $|(x, 1^T)|$ , i.e., polynomial in  $T$ .

Given input  $x$ , compute  $T$ , construct  $(x, 1^T)$ , and run the polynomial-time algorithm for  $A$ .

This takes time polynomial in  $T = 2^{n^k}$ , hence exponential in  $n$ .

Thus  $L \in EXP$ . Therefore  $NEXP \subseteq EXP$ .

Combining both inclusions,  $EXP = NEXP$ .

**Conclusion:** If  $P = NP$ , then  $EXP = NEXP$ .